



VertiGO!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 702 August 2007 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards.

Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Instructors learning to instruct! (Photo: Mike Courtney)



Section Night 6 TACKLING FOUR NORTH TWO YEARS

In his recent book, *No Viesturs* nicknamed one of his climbing tactics a “twofer”, and it’s a tactic that Nigel Roberts adopted both last year and this year.

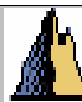
Nigel’s “twofer” tactic not only took him to the top of three US peaks higher than Mt Cook, but also enabled him to see some spectacular scenery in North America’s Wind River, Beartooth, and Cascade ranges.

On Monday evening 6 August, Nigel will talk about and show pictures of his twofer climbing trips.



**August 2007: TWOFER TRIPS –
AMERICAN MOUNTAIN IN**

Shortcuts to the Top, Ed



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



Latest from Mike O’Brien: Moonarie

I first heard of Moonarie from chatter around the Arapiles camp ground. Tempting tales of great routes in the outback that are seldom climbed and have a serious and isolated feel about them. We arrived after dark and the sight of the scorched red sandstone glowing in the light of the golden sunrise was promising. The scale of the cliffs became apparent during the hour long hike in. To the left and right, the cliffs stand solemnly with blank faces, broken by bulging buttresses and soaring corners. These main cliffs offer 3-4 pitch adventure climbs. However the highlight of Moonarie is the 50m Great Wall, sitting proudly at the end of the crag. The Great Wall is a slightly concave, blank looking wall, which is covered in 3 star classics. People rate these routes among the best they’ve ever done; they’re amazing!

Location: In the Flinders Ranges, South Australia, about 5 hours drive north of Adelaide. The campsite is about 10 minutes drive from Wilpena Pound Resort, and from camp it’s an hour walk up the hill to the crag.

Climbing: Predominantly trad routes from 45 to 130m long. Decent from the top usually involves a scramble down the central gully. Bring a full trad rack.

Grades: 9 – 28. Great long classic adventure routes from grade 12. 550+ routes.

Season: The area is on the fringe of the desert, meaning summer is hot and winter is cold. March to May and September to October are the best months.

Accommodation: Free camping under native Calatris Pines, on private land. The track from the road is usually okay for 2WD. No water or loos, so bring a shovel! Alternatively, Wilpenna Pound Resort has cabins etc, and is a ten minute drive away.

Services: Stock up on the way there as Wilpenna Pound Resort is very expensive. There are climbing stores in Adelaide.

Guidebook: 'Moonarie: A Rockclimber's Guide', by Tony Barker, is the only guide to Moonarie. It's vague, full of errors, and hard to use. Although it looks like a relic from the 70's, the last edition was actually published in 2000. Check www.climbingclubsouthaustralia.asn.au for updates.

Restday Activities: The Flinders Ranges are spectacular Australian style; baren, red, vast etc. Fun to explore for a day or two, but look out for emus and roos!

References: www.chockstone.org, or www.climbingclubsouthaustralia.asn.au to contact Adelaide climbers, and getting answers to Moonarie questions.

And Remember: amazing burgers at the Port Augusta Truck Stop, just off the main road, and 'Downwind of Angels', 19, is THE most amazing climb ever!

Mike O'Brien



AIC 2007

AIC 2007 – Week 1

Monday Morning; I have just discovered another bruise and I feel like I've spent the weekend in a tumble dryer.

I wonder if anyone else feels like this?

Welcome to AIC 2007!!

The weekend started without a hitch. The buses got away on time, there was no traffic to contend with – Kebabs at Bulls proved to be slow, but everyone was fed – and miraculously the 4x4 bus managed to get

all the way to Tukino hut!! Apparently the first time in AIC history. After a short briefing of the day to come the new AIC students tumbled into bed at the relatively timely hour of 1am.

Saturday dawned with that beautiful crisp freshness that you only get in the mountains. As the sun began to rise you could tell it was going to be a cracker of a day. No hint of the murky low pressure system that had been hanging over us for the previous few days. The AIC students were up and about (*Hey, so were the instructors! – Ed*) – not quite bright eyed and bushy tailed – but up all the same at 6.30am for a good wholesome breakfast.

Then we were off. Divided into our student groups we departed on our separate ways - Myself and Kate McKenzie with our instructor Pete de Joux and Assistant instructor Paul Mason. After spending some time familiarising ourselves with walking on steeper terrain without crampons we came to the first real lesson of the day: Ice-Axe Arrest!! For any of you that have done the AIC course you will know what this involves:

Step 1: Find very steep slope with good run out

Step 2: Nervously Slide down on bottom

Step 3: Nervously slide down on bottom with ice axe in hand

Step 4: Fling self down and attempt to stop

Step 5: Extract self from deep snow at bottom of slope, dry sunglasses, remove snow from neck

Step 6: Repeat. Upside down, back to front, upside down and back to front! Over and over again.....



Paul showing us how not to do it....

Once we'd established that the snow was possibly a little too soft to actually self arrest, and we'd all eaten our fair share of glaciated precipitation we stopped to catch breath, shake out our hoods and admire Pete's beginnings of 'The Snow Cave'.

An exciting afternoon followed with our group traversing some steep ground and practicing pigeonholing. Then Pete decided we were ready to attempt a climb on some steeper terrain. Paul and Scott disappeared up the slope to set up a good anchor point whilst the rest of us waited expectantly, nervously and coldly for the call to climb. Kate went first, quickly tying in and setting off, happy to get moving again. She made good time – if she was nervous then she didn't show it leaving me with a hard act to follow...

Then it was my turn. My fingers cold I fumbled with the rope tying in. As I looked up I could feel the butterflies start.. surely they didn't really expect me to go up there?? I kicked a tentative first step. It crumbled and I ended up where I'd started – the soft snow was not going to make things any easier for me! My second attempt was a little more successful and I managed to get some momentum. Driving the heads of my axe into the snow I kicked steps up to the first obstacle, rock covered by slushy snow. My heart was already racing and I could feel my legs trembling just slightly ('just don't look down' I kept telling myself). Somehow I managed to traverse a little and manoeuvre myself up and over the rock. Then I was away, one kick after the other, axes slipping in the slush (still not looking down), until after

what seemed a lifetime I could see the top. Then before I knew it I was there. First climb done and dusted. Success!!



Jo not really looking down...

High on adrenalin and still buzzing from the climb Pete set us to work on his snow cave. Earlier in the week we had discussed the possibility of us sleeping outside so came suitably equipped with warm sleeping bags, snow shovels and a sense of adventure. We were soon joined by a couple of other enthusiastic diggers and set to constructing a snow cave big enough for at least 5 to sleep in. Cosy would be the best way to describe the working conditions. But amongst the yelps and sorry's and other curious parties sticking their heads in (normally received by a face full of snow) our palatial dwelling was completed just in time for dinner. After a wonderful meal and a fascinating talk by Don French we gathered our necessary belongings and toddled off to our new home, much to the bemusement of the other AIC students. Much giggling and wriggling later we finally settled down and got some sleep. Not the most comfortable night I have ever spent as my sleeping platform was a bit wonky and I was either sliding off the side or slipping down to one end but remarkably warm nonetheless.



Kate emerging in the morning.

Sunday was a little calmer and we spent the day learning about navigation and glacier travel and the subsequent dangers. This again involved eating lots of snow – being rugby tackled by Pete (apparently this simulates falling into a crevasse?!), and dragged down a hill whilst relying on your buddy to stop you. Painful but enormous fun!!

Sadly the weekend couldn't last forever and in glorious sunshine, with just a hint of clouds starting to form on the horizon, we gently walked down to the mini buses and set off home.

So Monday morning and back in the office, I nurse my achy muscles and poke my new found bruises; I chuckle to myself and think 'yeah, bring on the next installment!!!'

Jo Langridge



NEWS FROM HEAD OFFICE

Day Usage of Huts

We have recently had a problem with day use at Ruapehu hut. It appears that some non-NZAC groups, that have been unable to make bookings at the hut, have decided to camp outside and still use the hut facilities. As we don't know who the groups were, we are unable to charge them a day use fee.

We would like members to know that should they come across a situation where large numbers of non-members are making use of our facilities without prior booking through the National Office, they should feel free to tactfully approach the group's leader and explain the terms of hut usage and day fee charges. If they feel uncomfortable in doing this, then members could take note of the group's name/numbers involved and let Margaret in the Head Office know. Hut etiquette and day use conditions are outlined on the Club's website here: <http://www.alpineclub.org.nz/default.aspx?p=75>

Members' assistance in keeping the office informed of problems at any of the Club's huts is extremely helpful and greatly appreciated.

Regards

Margaret McMahon

National Administrator

New Zealand Alpine Club Inc.

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Wellingtons Waterfront
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The New Website: <http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz>

We've finally switched on the new club website. We think you should all go and have a look at it and **Add to your Favourites**.

Here's a quick look at some of the features.....

The screenshot shows the website interface with several red callout boxes highlighting specific features:

- Subscribe to RSS** so that you're notified when updates are posted to the site (points to the RSS icon in the browser toolbar).
- Sort news by Category** (points to the 'Sort by' dropdown menu).
- Photo Galleries** (points to the 'Photo Galleries' link in the left sidebar).
- Quick tools for buying guidebooks, booking huts, buying or selling gear** (points to the 'Quick tools' section in the right sidebar).
- Even go on a date with a like minded climber (or other)** (points to the 'Upcoming Trip: Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu' section).
- Hover and click on the Events Calendar to see whats coming up month by month** (points to the 'Event Calendar' section).
- All the links to the good weather sites** (points to the 'Weather & Conditions' section in the right sidebar).

The website content includes:

- Header:** New Zealand Alpine Club Wellington Section
- Left Sidebar:** Home, About the club & membership, Email Discussion Groups, Climbing trips, Climbing Instruction, Rock Climbing, Club meetings, NZAC Club, NZAC National Home page, NZAC Book huts and ledges, NZAC Loan club gear, NZAC Buy & Sell, NZAC Find a climbing partner, NZAC Sites of interest, NZAC Weather & Conditions, NZAC Avalanche conditions, NZAC weather sites, NZAC Snow reports, NZAC US Navy Waikanae (HNDE) Webcam.
- Main Content:**
 - August club meeting: Nigel Roberts** (6 August, 2007, 8:00 pm to 10:00 pm). Nigel Roberts, immediate past Wellington Chairperson, will talk to us this month about his twelve month sabbatical from his role as Associate Professor of Political Science (surely an oxymoron if ever there was one.... apologies Nigel) when he succeeded in adding to his bag of big North American summits with ascents of Gannet Peak (4207m) the highest mountain in Wyoming and Granite Peak (3901m) the highest mountain in Montana.
 - Applications for The Distaghil Sar Award 2007** (31 July, 2007). The Wellington Section committee is now calling for applications for the Distaghil Sar Award. Applications close 31st July 2007.
 - Upcoming Trip: Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu** (20 July, 2007 to 22 July, 2007). Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu. Leaders: AJ Bryant, Level: AIC Graduate and up. The plan is to drive up to Whakarekare, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Corrie shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratitahonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2722m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter.
 - 2007 Photo Competition Results**. This year's photo competition was even bigger than last years with
- Right Sidebar:**
 - News Categories:** Barff Film Festival (1), Club meetings (5), Club notices (2), Climbing events (24), Competitions (3), Distaghil Sar Award (1), Instruction Courses (6), Local Buy & Sell (5), Photo competition (2), Rock climbing (4), Situations Vacant (1), Trip reports (21), Upcoming trips (9).
 - Contribute:** Get news or information to share?
 - Quick tools:** Join the NZAC, Book huts and ledges, Loan club gear, Buy a guidebook, National Buy & Sell, Find a climbing partner.
 - Sites of interest:** Arthur's Pass, Mountaineering, Central NZ Is, rockclimbing guide, majaveona, Outdoor links, Payson's and, etc.
 - Weather & Conditions:** Avalanche conditions, NZ weather sites, Snow reports, US Navy Waikanae (HNDE) Webcam.



NZAC Wellington Section Photo Competition 2007 - Results

This year's photo competition was even bigger than last years with 25 contestants entering over 160 images.

Overall the quality of the field was much better than last years with five Champions, ten Honours and 75 Acceptances found. Also of note was the improvement in photography skills seen in a number of contestants that entered in last year's competition.

In all nine prizes were awarded – this amounted to one prize for each contestant who achieved a Champion or Honours photograph.

Champions

- Champion Humour: Sandfly Man by Kevin Patterson
- Champion Rock Climbing The Rack by Caroline Horrox
- Champion Alpine Nature Celmesia at Arthur's Pass by Alison Stevenson
- Champion Alpine Activity Skiing into the Sunset by Katja Reidel

Best of the Rest's

- Honours Alpine Nature Mammoths Rest by David Eaton
- Honours Alpine General Sefton from Welcome Pass by Terry Crippen
- Honours Alpine Nature Kakariki on myrsine divaricta by Andy Maloney

Most Improved

- Honours Alpine Nature Artic Tern by Anjali Pande
- Crowds by Anjali Pande

Overall Champion

- Champion Alpine General Fox Neve by Paul Grimwood

A full set of results can be viewed at <http://www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz>

Our:

- congratulations is extended to all the winners and achievers
- thanks is extended to Shaun Barnett our Judge who laboured over Queen's Birthday weekend to complete the judging and presentation
- thanks to the sponsors for again supporting the event with some marvelous prizes

This year's photo competition sponsored by:



The Champions



Overall Champion

Fox Neve

by Paul Grimwood

Ski touring package valued at \$130 awarded by:



Champion: Alpine Activity

Skiing into the Sunset

by Katja Reidel

\$100 Gift Voucher awarded by:



Champion: Rock Climbing

The Rack

by Caroline Horrox

\$40 Gift Voucher awarded by:





Champion: Alpine Nature

Celmisia at Arthur's Pass

by Alison Stevenson

\$40 Gift Voucher awarded by:



Champion: Humour

Sandfly Man

by Kevin Patterson

\$40 Gift Voucher awarded by:



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AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

Trips for the Calendar for 2007 so far...

24-26Aug07 - Ruapehu South - Girdlestone and Taurangi – Leader Neville Palmer – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience – **TRIP FULL!**

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Taurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the only peak on the right of Taurangi by crossing the Mangaehu Glacier. Contact Neville at 569 2990 (evenings) or email mail@nev.co.nz

21-23Sep07 - Egmont - via Taurangi lodge – Leader TBA – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

We will leave early on Friday afternoon (4pm) to North Egmont car park, from where we will tramp up to Taurangi Lodge (1.5h) arriving ca. 11pm. On Saturday we will ascend Egmont (2518m) via the Lizard, returning to the lodge for the evening. On Sunday we will explore the rock walls of Warwick Castle (bring a rope for this trip) towards the eastern side before returning to the car park. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

19-22Oct07 - Cupola - Nelson Lakes – Leader Rachel Schmidt – Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Labour Weekend trip - time for a bit of South Island powder snow and true alpine peaks experience! We will take the ferry then hire car to Nelson Lakes on Friday night, staying in the backpackers at St Arnaud. On Saturday we will take the water taxi to the far end of Lake Rotoiti, and then tramp up to Cupola Hut (7h). On Sunday we will climb Cupola, return and descend to John Tait Hut. Monday is for the walk out, water taxi, ferry back to Wellington. Contact Rachael rs@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

9-12Nov07 - Mueller - Leader = Rachael Schmidt/Garth London - Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Most likely we will be flying to Christchurch on Friday night then driving to Mt Cook Village (arriving ca. 11pm) staying at Unwin Hut. Otherwise some ferry/drive combination is envisaged. A number of options are possible including Barron Saddle Hut, and Mts Olivier, Kitchener and Sealy. Details to come. Contact Garth gl@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz or Rachael rs@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

29Dec07 – 5Jan08 – Annual NZAC Climbing Camp – Hopkins Valley

South Canterbury – Based at Huxley Lodge. Watch the National NZAC website for details as they arise - www.alpineclub.org.nz

18-23Jan08 – NZAC North Island Rock Climbing Camp – Mt Egmont (Taranaki). Watch this space for details as they develop.

8-10Feb08 – Taranaki Rock – Leader = James Wright

Weekend trip to climb the rock on Mt Taranaki. Most likely we will be based from Taurangi lodge on the Northern Slopes. Multiple rock routes on various pillars and outcrops including Humphries Castle. Contact James Wright at james.wright@xtra.co.nz or call at (04) 232-7748 or (027) 4725-561.

May08 - Frog Buttress, Queensland – Leader = Rachel Schmidt

4 days - in and out Brisbane, followed by 4 days surfing/diving on North Stradbroke Island for those who want to come, otherwise those who want to just climb, can come for the first 4 days. Contact Rachael rs@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



MOVED HOUSE?

Please notify the Club's National Administrator of your change of address as the labels for all newsletters and club publications are generated at the HQ office.

You can contact:

Margaret McMahon
National Administrator
email margaret@alpineclub.org.nz

NZAC
PO BOX 786
CHRISTCHURCH
TEL (03) 377 7595
FAX (03) 337 7594)



Bored at work?

Check out www.mountainz.co.nz

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/taranaki.html>

Central NI Volcanoes from Taupo

<http://www.taupodc.govt.nz/AboutTaupoDistrict/WebCam.htm>

Mount Ngauruhoe

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/ngauruhoe.html>

Mount Ruapehu – from Chateau

<http://www.geonet.org.nz/ruapehu.html>

Mount Ruapehu – from Ohakune

<http://www.unique-art-gallery.com/gallery/webcam1.htm>

Tararuas from Wellington

<http://www.wn.co.nz/cameras/cam01.php>

Nelson Lakes

<http://www.snow.co.nz/clients/nelsonlakes/webcam.asp>

Castle Hill Basin

<http://www.castlehill.net.nz/webcam.htm>

Mt Cook

<http://www.alpineguides.co.nz/popup/cam.htm>

Two Thumb range & Multi Brun (east)

<http://www.tekapotourism.com/webcam.htm>

Aspiring

http://www.lakewanaka.co.nz/index.cfm/web_cam/

Queenstown

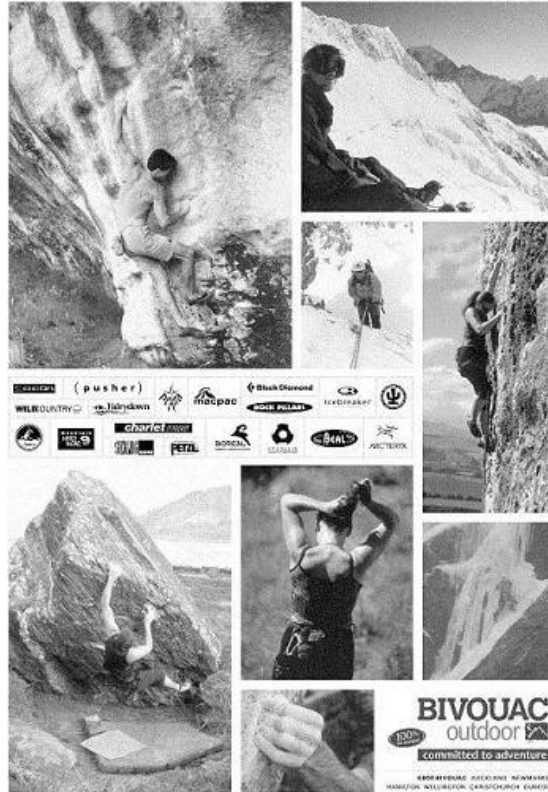
<http://www.skyline.co.nz/queenstown/webcam/>

Scott Base

<http://www.antarcticanz.govt.nz/education/2568>

Allsorts of others at

<http://www.enzed.com/cam.html>

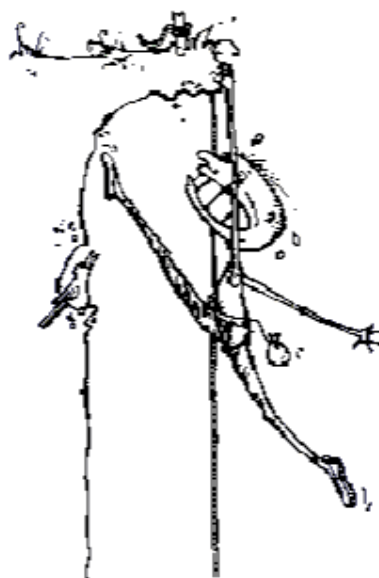




Wellington Section Directory: 2007 contact list

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron			
Chairperson	Garth London	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Vice Chairperson	Jennifer Brown	JB2	027 292 0903
Secretary	Rachel Depree	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RD	N/A
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	475 8453 <i>or</i> 021 503 097
National Representative	Jennifer Brown and James Wright	JB2 <i>or</i> JW	N/A
	Garth London and Judy Reid	GL <i>or</i> JR	(04) 479 2984 (Garth)
Instruction: AIC	Rachael Schmidt	RS <i>or</i> AIC	(04) 494 5643
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SPRINGROCK	N/A
National Instruction Rep	Rachael Schmidt	RS	(04) 494 5643
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS <i>or</i> KP	N/A
	Gwen Rashbrooke	TRIPS <i>or</i> GR	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
Committee Members	Hayden Cox	HC	(04) 976 3365
	Paul Grimwood	PG	N/A
	Pete de Joux	PD	N/A
	Blair Hiscoke	BH	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
	Catherine Moger	CM2	N/A
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Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Judy Reid	JR	N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



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